NOVA® HOME LOANS

NOVA Home Loans Taps Polly for Unique Configuration; Unlocks Greater Agility, Competitiveness, and Profitability

/ COMPANY PROFILE

NOVA Home Loans is a well-established mortgage lender that has been helping borrowers achieve their homeownership goals for more than 40 years. Founded in 1980, NOVA has a robust retail focus that accounts for 99% of its multi-billion-dollar business.

Headquartered in Tucson, AZ, approximately 70% of NOVA's business is derived from its home state, cementing its position as Arizona's largest privately-owned mortgage lender. Even so, NOVA has continued to grow significantly in recent years, expanding its brick-and-mortar locations in Colorado and throughout the Pacific Northwest. NOVA Home Loans is currently licensed in 19 states.

/ OVERVIEW

Before the company's introduction to Polly, NOVA had been operating with the same product and pricing engine (PPE) provider for several years. While satisfied with the functionality of its prior engine, that PPE provider had undergone a series of mergers and acquisitions that resulted in the sunset of NOVA's original engine, and a dominant legacy engine taking the reins. Executives at NOVA faced a stark choice: Proceed with this forced migration or take back control.

After a thorough evaluation and market analysis, NOVA decided to replace its pricing engine with Polly's cloud-native, high-performance PPE. Executives cited the immediate configurability, flexibility, and scalability of the platform as key drivers in their decision process.

To avoid any disruption across NOVA's secondary marketing and loan officer (LO) teams, it was crucial that Polly could deliver all the previous functionality and personalization they were accustomed to, including a myriad of personalized business rules, unique fields and associated mappings that had been configured over the span of NOVA's 15+ years using the Encompass® LOS. A seamless integration with BeSmartee was equally important.

Implementation of Polly's pricing engine and loan trading exchange (LTE) began in March 2023. The first of NOVA's 25+ branches went live in June, and because of a very intentional and thorough phased approach, the remaining branches were completed just 2 months later. Ultimately, Polly delivered a robust, cutting-edge solution. Its platform seamlessly integrated with NOVA's existing mortgage tech stack, and its functionality has since far exceeded NOVA's expectations.

/ RESULTS

- **Seamless, thoughtful implementation avoids disruption and maximizes accuracy:** Implementation of all NOVA branches was completed in under 6 months. Within this accelerated period, Polly seamlessly configured a myriad of unique business rules and 15+ years of fully customized LOS field mappings. A thoughtful and phased approach ensured a smooth PPE transition across subsequent branches.

- **Measurable wins in lock desk program management and execution:** With Polly, NOVA was able to save substantial time with new lock desk programs. The company successfully launched 13 new programs in its first 7 months using Polly, 6 of which were custom-built to match distinct matrices. Because NOVA was able to self-service these builds, lock desk personnel cut build time to just 2 hours, a significant time savings in comparison to the typical 2-day turn time required by their previous vendor to build.

/ THE DETAILS

Configurability and customization are key

Before NOVA's implementation of Polly, the company had invested a sizable amount of time and energy into the customization of its LOS. According to Mark Papay, NOVA's Senior Vice President of Capital Markets, ensuring that Polly's PPE could adequately support this level of customization was of the utmost importance.

"Our level of personalization has historically complicated the integration process, but I was pleasantly surprised to find that this was never a concern or hurdle with Polly. The team was more than willing to do whatever it took to make NOVA's desired customization and layout a reality. Their dedication to supporting the complexities of our business was evident throughout the implementation and onboarding process."

Post-implementation, NOVA continues to be impressed by Polly's functional depth and flexibility. In particular, the team has found incredible value in how easy it is to configure rules and guidelines, customize margins, and quickly distribute unique pricing across all channels. Additionally, NOVA has recognized Polly's positive impact on its agility and speed-to-market amid today's challenging and increasingly competitive market environment. Using Polly's self-service configuration capabilities, NOVA expanded its footprint by launching 13 new programs within the first 7 months of using the PPE, 6 of which were custom-built from the ground up. NOVA can easily test any new product and/or strategy in development to fine tune them before publishing to a live environment – a valuable capability that is unique to Polly.

"NOVA's success is largely dependent on our team, the technology we leverage, and how those two components work in tandem to optimize our operations. I'm confident that we are in a great place with Polly. We're now 100% in control of our pricing engine and strategic direction, and can only continue to evolve from here," added Papay.

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>
> **Mark Papay**,
> Senior Vice President of Capital Markets

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Fueling LOs with the right technology

As the public face and champion of any financial institution, the loan officer is a critical stakeholder in the mortgage tech procurement process. And like many leading mortgage lenders, NOVA recognizes the importance of equipping their LOs with the right technology.

When NOVA surveyed its 150+ LOs about their desired PPE functionality, one request quickly rose to the top of the priority list: *mobile functionality*.

Polly has dedicated significant resources to pioneering a cutting-edge, mobile-responsive pricing engine. Its solution enables NOVA's loan officers to quickly pull accurate and on-the-go pricing, meeting their borrowers at the point of need. From Polly's perspective, this is another way to help LOs stand apart from the crowd in a difficult mortgage market where the competition for borrowers is increasingly high.

"We prioritize the needs of our sales force," explained Papay. "And during the procurement process, our LOs were talking about Polly. They want access to modern technology that's easy to use, intuitive, reliable, and accurate. From the viewpoint of our LOs, Polly checks all the boxes."

Second on the list: *Advanced pipeline monitoring*.

NOVA leverages Polly's preemptive pipeline monitoring to ensure its pricing remains competitive and profitable.

Multiple factors are at play here. First, Polly's pipeline monitoring enables proactive issue resolution and streamlines NOVA's processes, saving valuable time and resources. Second, it improves turnaround times by enabling NOVA to process more loans, faster. Borrowers can lock in more favorable rates, which is crucial to winning business in a challenging market. Lastly, Polly's pipeline monitoring enables NOVA to quickly identify compliance issues or loans that are at risk of falling out of eligibility, so it can take proactive measures to protect itself and its borrowers.

"Pipeline monitoring is essential to our business, as we want our lock desk and loan officers to be the first to know of any changes that could impact price and borrower eligibility," added Papay. "We're pleased that Polly's capabilities have exceeded our expectations in this regard."

Building a solution - and partnership - for the future

Since its inception, Polly has been unwavering in its commitment to superior customer service. This commitment was demonstrated throughout the implementation and onboarding of NOVA Home Loans.

Polly worked closely and collaboratively with the NOVA team to ensure that all aspects of the integration went smoothly. The channels of communication and collaboration have extended to NOVA's engagement with the customer success team. "Throughout training and now its active customer success communications, Polly's team does a tremendous job," said Papay. "Our dedicated point of contact is knowledgeable and always engaged; it just makes our lives so much easier."

According to Papay, this feeling is shared across his entire team. "Whether I am talking to my loan officers or my lock desk, the team raves about Polly and continues to tell me that we absolutely made the right decision!"

"Polly will always work with our customer partners to build the right solution for them, no matter the complexity or customization desired. Our purpose is to deliver incredible value to their business," shared Adam Carmel, Founder and CEO of Polly. "I am thankful for the trust that NOVA Home Loans has placed in Polly. As its business evolves, we will continue to collaborate and tailor our platform to meet and exceed its expectations. We look forward to serving this team for years to come."

/ CONTACT

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